



THE BULLPEN

By Lester Koelling

PLAYOFF ARGUMENTS BLASTED

THERE'LL be no playoff worries and the resulting financial loss to plague the management of Indians, Inc., this year, the first real "break" in an otherwise dismal and frustrating season.

This also might be the last year for the post-season folly, which is beginning to lose the affection of some American Association directors. Certainly, one of the strongest arguments presented by the directors to justify the playoffs has been knocked for a loop.

For years, the directors have argued long and sometimes loud that playoff possibilities stimulated attendance in those cities no longer a contender in the pennant race. But that balloon of faith and hope has been punctured and directors will have to look elsewhere for evidence to substantiate their arguments.

In recent weeks, attendance figures in those cities out of the pennant race but still in playoff contention have been alarmingly low. Omaha, for example, averaged less than 2,000 and had only two crowds as big as 2,500 while still in the running for a playoff berth.

St. Paul, also battling for a playoff spot which wasn't assured until night before last, likewise averaged less than 2,000, and in a season wherein the club more than doubled its total attendance over 1956. Minneapolis, which had an outside chance for the pennant—and major league franchise—did a little better with a 3,000 average, but even that was below the daily average going into the last two weeks of the home season.

It all adds up to the plain and simple fact that fans no longer can be sold on the outmoded playoffs. But so long as the A.A. directors choose to be guided and influenced by the International League, the poisonous playoffs will be with us.

The Indians, with their forces cut to 17 players, left by plane today for Wichita where they will begin the season's final series with a double-header tonight. Missing from the squad were Barry Latman, who joined the Chicago White Sox, and Jose Valdivielso and Dick DiTusa, who went to their homes with injuries.

Jim McDonald, who will report to the White Sox next Monday, and Roy Tinney, an optionee from the Boston Red Sox, are scheduled for to-

night's pitching duties. Most of the players will take off for their homes from Wichita after the season finale Sunday night. A few will come back to Indianapolis, along with Manager Andy Cohen, who expects to take off by auto next Monday night for his home in Elmira, N.Y.

Also heading for the White Sox Monday will be Ron Jackson and Jim Landis. The Sox have recalled John Romano, Don Prohovich and Bill DuFour, but they will not report until next spring.

Eleven players in the Chicago White Sox chain, and optioned to smaller leagues, have been recalled by the Indianapolis management for placement on the winter roster. If the Indians and White Sox work together again next year, they will report to the Indianapolis club at Hollywood, Fla., next spring.

The recalled players are Pitchers Roger Howard, Glen Rosenbaum, Richard Ramos and Rodolfo Arias, and Outfielder Ron Cooper from Colorado Springs; Pitchers Ed Szycewski and Hal Trosky from Davenport; Pitcher Phil Brown and First Baseman J. C. Martin from Dubuque; First Baseman Don Mincher from Duluth-Superior, and Outfielder John Callison from Bakersfield, Cal.

Score Probable Pitch Again

By United Press

CLEVELAND—Eye Specialist Dr. Charles I. Thomas said today that Pitcher Herb Score probably will not return to action this year.

However, Thomas declined to say definitely that the hard-throwing pitcher was through for the season. Thomas, who has treated Score since the hurler was struck in the eye by a batted ball May 7, said the southpaw would undergo a new training program to improve his depth perception.

The specialist declined to reveal the nature of the new program, but indicated Score will focus his eye on various objects. The program will be conducted in Thomas' office and Score's home.